

“THE GREATEST COMFORTS AND LASTING PEACE ARE OBTAINED, WHEN ONE ERADICATES SELFISHNESS FROM WITHIN.”

Guru Gobind Singh, 10th Sikh Master, 1697

THE NINE YEARS' WAR THAT HAD SEEN FRANCE TAKE ON the Grand Alliance of England, the Holy Roman Empire, Spain, and the Dutch Republic was **ended by the Treaty of Ryswick** in 1697. It established that all territory taken since 1679 was to be returned.

The Ottoman defeat at the Siege of Vienna in 1683 marked not just the beginning of a protracted Ottoman decline, but the **emergence of Habsburg Austria** as a European power to challenge France, England, and the Dutch Republic. After 1683, Austrian Imperial armies pursued the retreating Ottomans south across the Balkans, a process that climaxed at the **Battle of Zenta**, in Serbia in September 1697. Under the Italo-French general Eugene of Savoy (1663–1736), who

Treaty of Ryswick
The treaty was signed at the palace of Huis ter Nieuwburg, the country house of William of Orange, in Ryswick, in the Dutch Republic.



was rapidly emerging as one of the foremost commanders in Europe, an Imperial army surprised the Ottomans as they attempted to cross the Tisa River. The Ottomans were massacred: about 10,000 drowned, and a further 20,000 were killed in battle. The **Treaty of Karlowitz** in 1699 confirmed the Austrian

gains, including the gradual absorption of Hungary by the Austrian crown. In July 1698, English military engineer **Thomas Savery** (1650–1715) registered a patent for “a new invention for raising of water... of great use and advantage for drayning mines.” Basic forms of steam power had existed since the 1st century CE, but none of these had ever been translated into working machines. Savery’s **steam engine was basic**, prone to violent explosions, and unable to pump water more than 33 ft (10 m) below it, meaning that in mines it had to be installed, dangerously, underground. It was only in 1721 when Thomas Newcomen (1664–1729), working with Savery, produced his **atmospheric engine**, that a viable commercial use was found. Yet, the real potential of steam as an **engine of industrialization** would not be realized until the invention by the Scot, James Watt (1736–1819), in 1769, of a separate condenser, and then only with the backing of English businessman Matthew Boulton (see pp.274–75).

MUGHAL EMPIRE

The crushing of a Sikh revolt in the Punjab in 1699 saw the Mughal Empire at its zenith. From its Afghan heartlands, it had grown under Akbar, taking all but the tip of India’s subcontinent by the end of the 17th century. The harsh rule of Aurangzeb saw many revolts, and the later rise of the Marathas (see 1720) left the Mughals as puppets.

KEY

- Akbar’s domains, 1556
- Additional areas held by Mughals at Akbar’s death, 1605
- Additional areas acquired up to the death of Aurangzeb, 1707



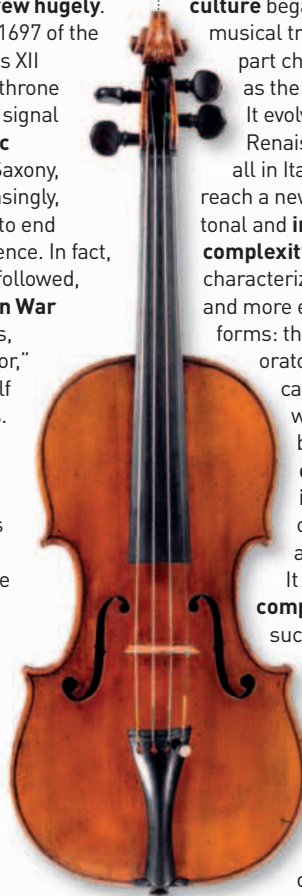
An engraving depicting 16-year-old Philip, duke of Anjou, being recognized as Philip V, king of Spain, on October 2, 1700.

THE DEATH IN 1700 OF CHARLES II, the childless king of Spain, caused a major crisis when he nominated Philip of Anjou (1683–1746), the grandson of Louis XIV of France, as his successor. Charles hoped that French power would preserve the **Spanish Empire** if ruled by a **Bourbon**. Louis accepted the vast increase in family prestige and French influence, but **opposition** to the succession and its increase in French power **grew hugely**.

The accession in 1697 of the 15-year-old Charles XII (1682–1718) to the throne of Sweden was the signal for **Sweden’s Baltic rivals**, Denmark, Saxony, Poland, and, increasingly, Russia, to attempt to end Swedish pre-eminence. In fact, in the conflict that followed, the **Great Northern War** of 1700–21, Charles, “the Swedish Meteor,” would prove himself a general of genius. In the four months from August 1700, he successively defeated the Danes and then, over on the other side of the Baltic, at Narva,

annihilated a Russian army four times the size of his own. The following July, he inflicted a similarly crushing defeat on a combined Polish–Saxon force at Klissow in Poland. With **Sweden never more dominant**, Charles’s bold campaigning, whatever the odds against him, had apparently been wholly vindicated.

From about 1700, a **major development in European culture** began to take shape: a musical tradition, part courtly, part church-based, known as the **High Baroque**. It evolved from later Renaissance music, above all in Italy, but developed to reach a new level of polyphonic tonal and **instrumental complexity**. It was characterized by both new and more elaborated musical forms: the concerto, fugue, oratorio, prelude, cantata, and opera. It was made possible by **new forms of existing instruments**: the organ, harpsichord, and, above all, violin. It depended also on **composers of genius**, such as Johann Sebastian Bach (1685–1750) and George Handel (1685–1759), and on a more extensive world of courtly and private patronage of them.



Stradivarius violin
The Stradivarius violin, made by Italian Antonio Stradivari, entered a golden age in 1700. These violins were larger than earlier models.

September 11, 1697 Ottomans defeated at Battle of Zenta
September 20, 1697 Treaty of Ryswick ends Nine Years' War
1697 Czar Peter the Great tours Western Europe
1697 Polish nobles elect Augustus the Strong of Saxony, as king of Poland
1697 Russia launches conquest of Kamchatka, Siberia
1698 Omanis capture Mombasa
1698 London Stock Exchange founded
1698 Isaac Newton calculates speed of sound
April 13, 1699 Guru Gobind Singh creates Sikh military order, the Khalsa
July 2, 1698 Thomas Savery patents first steam engine
August 1698 Streletsy Uprising suppressed, Russia
January 26, 1699 Treaty of Karlowitz ends Austro-Turkish War
1699 Omanis capture Zanzibar
1699 Mughals suppress Sikhs in Punjab; Mughal power now at height
1699 William Dampier explores New Guinea

January 26 Cascadia Earthquake, North America
February 12 Great Northern War begins
May 12 English poet John Dryden dies (b. 1631)
November 1 Death of Charles II of Spain (b. 1661); accession of Philip V
November 20 Sweden defeats Russia at Battle of Narva, in Estonia
Russo-Turkish War ends after two years
November 1 Vietnamese gain control of entire Indochina Peninsula
Rise of Bantu Kingdom of Buganda, East Africa